

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 83 OF 102

Shafran's Hexagonal Chess

70 hexes (9 files a-i)

BOARD

2

PLAYERS

SHAFRAN'S HEXAGONAL CHESS

Invented by Boris Shafran. Played on a smaller 70-hex board with 9 files (a through i). Castling is permitted and the pawn initial step varies by file.

SETUP

Board: 70-hex irregular hexagonal grid, 9 files (a-i), 10 ranks. File lengths: a(6), b(7), c(8), d(9), e(10), f(9), g(8), h(7), i(6). Files a-e share the bottom edge; files e-i share the top edge.

White pieces (back rank, bottom edge):

- ♦ King on e1
- ♦ Queen on d1
- ♦ Bishops on c1, f2, h4 (one per colour)
- ♦ Knights on b1, g3
- ♦ Rooks on a1, i5
- ♦ Pawns on a2, b2, c2, d2, e2, f3, g4, h5, i6 (9 pawns)

Black pieces (back rank, top edge – 180° rotation):

- ♦ King on e10
- ♦ Queen on f10
- ♦ Bishops on g10, d9, b7 (one per colour)
- ♦ Knights on h10, c8
- ♦ Rooks on i10, a6
- ♦ Pawns on i9, h9, g9, f9, e9, d8, c7, b6, a5 (9 pawns)

PAWNS

Pawns capture diagonally (bishop direction, through shared corners). The initial step from the starting rank depends on the pawn's file:

FILES	INITIAL STEP
d, e, f	1, 2, or 3 cells forward
b, c, g, h	1 or 2 cells forward
a, i	1 cell only

CASTLING

Castling is permitted on both the Queen-side and King-side. The King moves two cells toward the Rook; the Rook moves to the other side of the King.

RULES

Identical to standard chess adapted for the hex grid except as noted. Stalemate is a draw.

WIN CONDITION

Checkmate.

ATTRIBUTION

Boris Shafran. Public domain rules.